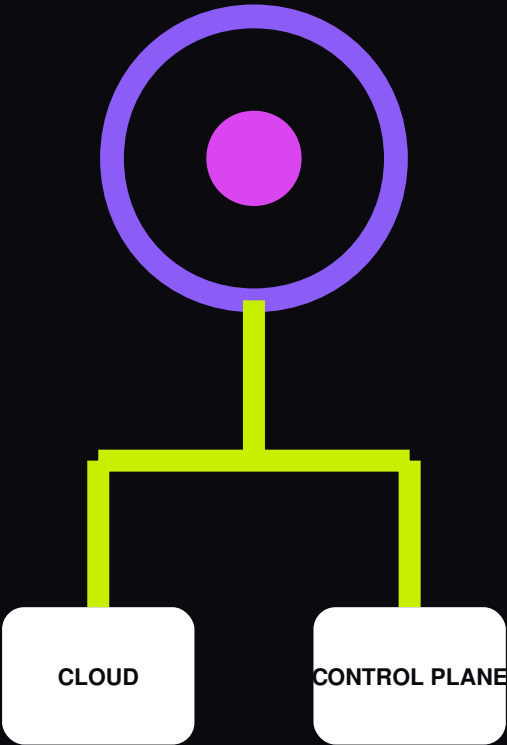


AZURE CONTROL- PLANE RESOURCE DELETION

Hunts Azure administrative events that delete storage accounts, Key Vaults, Function Apps, App Services, or App Service plans.

HUNTING QUERY

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM



EVIDENCE BEFORE ALERTING

REPORT DATE

1 October 2026

STATUS

Untested implementation
sketch

PRIMARY PLATFORM

Microsoft Sentinel

OPERATIONAL VALUE

9.8 / 10



EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision, confidence and evidence boundary.

ASSESSMENT

OPERATIONAL VALUE

9.8

Hunts Azure administrative events that delete storage accounts, Key Vaults, Function Apps, App Services, or App Service plans.

STATUS

Hunting query

Untested implementation sketch; Confidence Medium.

1primary table

0joins

0secondary rules

2validation gates

Evidence boundary

A result proves only that Azure emitted one of the selected administrative delete operations. It does not prove compromise, Storm-3168 attribution, successful deletion, data loss, credential theft, or exfiltration.



BEHAVIOR AND EVIDENCE

Observed facts separated from analytical scope.

MECHANICS

Source-supported fact

- 1 Microsoft observed a compromised service principal perform more than 150 destructive or credential-collection operations in about 35 minutes in June 2026.
- 2 The destructive phase lasted about seven minutes and included more than 100 storage-account deletion attempts, most reported successful by Microsoft.
- 3 Microsoft also confirmed successful deletion of a Key Vault, Function App, and App Service plan; SQL deletion attempts failed because of an unsupported API version.

Detection hypothesis

If an attacker repeats this behavior, AzureActivity should expose the same source-supported resource deletion operations. Distinction requires caller ownership, resource scope, status, and approved-change context.

Unconfirmed elements

A result proves only that Azure emitted one of the selected administrative delete operations. It does not prove compromise, Storm-3168 attribution, successful deletion, data loss, credential theft, or exfiltration.

Logic: Behavioral control-plane operations **ATT&CK:** T1485



TELEMETRY CONTRACT

Collection prerequisites and field reliability.

TELEMETRY

REQUIRED

Microsoft Sentinel Azure Activity connector streaming Azure subscription Activity Log records into the AzureActivity table.

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

Service-principal ownership, change records, deployment pipeline identity, resource criticality, ActivityStatusValue, Authorization_d, Claims_d, Properties_d, and adjacent ListKeys events.

Fields	Reliability	Use
TimeGenerated, SubscriptionId	Documented	Query or triage
CategoryValue, OperationNameValue	Documented	Query or triage
ResourceGroup, ResourceId	Documented	Query or triage
ResourceProviderValue, ActivityStatusValue	Documented	Query or triage
Caller, CallerIpAddress	Documented	Query or triage
CorrelationId, Authorization_d	Documented	Query or triage
Properties_d	Documented	Query or triage
Service-principal ownership / change record	Environment-dependent	Query or triage

Excluded

No inferred deletion success, actor attribution, arbitrary threshold, IOC dependency, or undocumented cross-SIEM mapping is used.



PRIMARY KQL

Direct source-supported conditions with investigable output.

HUNTING

STATUS

Hunting query — Untested implementation sketch

KQL — UNTESTED

```
AzureActivity
| where CategoryValue =~ "Administrative"
| where OperationNameValue in~ (
    "MICROSOFT.STORAGE/STORAGEACCOUNTS/DELETE",
    "MICROSOFT.KEYVAULT/VAULTS/DELETE",
    "MICROSOFT.WEB/SITES/DELETE",
    "MICROSOFT.WEB/SERVERFARMS/DELETE"
)
| project TimeGenerated, SubscriptionId, ResourceGroup,
    ResourceProviderValue, ResourceId,
    OperationNameValue, ActivityStatusValue,
    Caller, CallerIpAddress, CorrelationId,
    Authorization_d, Properties_d
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

WINDOW

Analyst-selected;
none embedded

THRESHOLD

None

JOIN / SEQUENCE

None

STATUS FILTER

None; retain
success and failure



TRIAGE AND TUNING

Human validation before response.

WORKFLOW

1

Preserve

Retain the raw Activity Log event, caller, IP, resource identifiers, status, CorrelationId, Authorization_d, and Properties_d.

2

Confirm

Identify the caller or service principal, resource owner, deployment pipeline, and matching change record.

3

Enrich

Service-principal ownership, change records, deployment pipeline identity, resource criticality, ActivityStatusValue, Authorization_d, Claims_d, Properties_d, and adjacent ListKeys events.

4

Scope

Review adjacent Azure control-plane reads, ListKeys operations, recovery-control changes, sign-ins, and resource-health evidence.

Expected benign overlap

Legitimate Terraform or ARM teardown, subscription cleanup, disaster-recovery tests, application retirement, and administrator error can emit the same operations. Tune only with verified owner, identity, resource scope, and approved change context.

Response boundary

A result proves only that Azure emitted one of the selected administrative delete operations. It does not prove compromise, Storm-3168 attribution, successful deletion, data loss, credential theft, or exfiltration.



VALIDATION GATES

Controlled tests and cross-SIEM limits.

QUALITY CONTROL

Validation steps

1. Delete a disposable test resource through an approved change and retain the raw AzureActivity event.
2. Confirm the exact OperationNameValue strings, CategoryValue, status, caller representation, CorrelationId, and resource identifiers.
3. Measure benign deletion volume and map recurring callers to deployment pipelines, owners, and change records.
4. Test failed and successful deletes; confirm the hunt retains both and that triage can distinguish them from ActivityStatusValue and Properties_d.

Decision criteria

Success: The authorized test returns the exact operation with complete caller, resource, status, and correlation context; recurring legitimate deletes are attributable.

Rejection: The connector omits required delete operations or caller/resource context is too incomplete to distinguish governed teardown from suspicious activity.

Failure: Missing subscription diagnostic export, ingestion delay, operation-name variation, truncated dynamic fields, management outside Azure Resource Manager, or absent ownership data.

Platform	Decision	Missing evidence
Microsoft Sentinel	Hunting query	Tenant baseline and validation
Splunk	No reliable implementation	Index, sourcetype, parser, sample
Chronicle	No reliable implementation	Parser and exact UDM mapping



CONCLUSION AND REFERENCES

Coverage statement and document control.

FINAL

CONCLUSION

Hunting query

Hunts Azure administrative events that delete storage accounts, Key Vaults, Function Apps, App Services, or App Service plans.

A result proves only that Azure emitted one of the selected administrative delete operations. It does not prove compromise, Storm-3168 attribution, successful deletion, data loss, credential theft, or exfiltration.

MITRE ATT&CK

T1485

References

1. Microsoft Security Research - Storm-3168 - 25 Sep 2026
2. Microsoft Learn - AzureActivity table schema
3. Microsoft Learn - Azure Activity connector and Activity Log schema
4. MITRE ATT&CK - T1485 Data Destruction

Document control

English dossier. No customer data. URLs are defanged in references.txt. HTML and rendering assets remain private.